

ATHEISM: A GROWING CHALLENGE

Today, I am not standing before you to insult an atheist.

I am standing before you with a question.

If humanity can spend billions searching for life somewhere in the universe... why are we becoming less curious about the One who gave us life?

Atheism is no longer a distant philosophical discussion.

It is appearing in our classrooms.

In our social media feeds.

In our conversations.

And increasingly, in the minds of young people.

But why?

Is it because science has disproved God?

No.

Science explains how many things happen.

But science does not answer every question of existence.

It can explain how a heartbeat functions.

But can it explain why life exists at all?

It can describe the universe.

But can it answer why there is a universe rather than nothing?

These are not questions that disappear simply because technology advances.

My dear friends,

One of the greatest challenges today is not science.

It is the belief that science and faith must be enemies.

They don't have to be.

Science studies the creation.

Faith asks us to think about the Creator.

Sometimes, people do not reject religion because they have studied it deeply.

They reject the behaviour of religious people.

When a young person sees hypocrisy...

When he sees hatred in the name of religion...

When he sees injustice committed by people who speak constantly about God...

He may not reject hypocrisy.

He may reject God Himself.

And that is where believers must look into the mirror.

If our religion teaches mercy, but we show cruelty...

If it teaches honesty, but we practice deception...

If it teaches justice, but we tolerate injustice...

then our biggest problem may not be the atheist questioning faith.

It may be the believer failing to represent it.

So when a young person asks,

“Does God exist?”

Don't silence him.

Talk to him.

When he asks,

“Why should I believe?”

Don't insult him.

Give him reasons.

And when he says,

“I don't understand,”

Don't say,

“Then you are lost.”

Say, “Let us search together.”

Because faith that cannot survive a sincere question is not strong faith.

And knowledge without humility can become arrogance.

My dear friends,

Atheism is not merely a debate to be won.

It is a question that demands an answer.

And perhaps the greatest answer is not found in an argument.
It is found in a life that makes people ask:

“What gives this person such peace, purpose, justice and compassion?”

Let us build believers who think.
Believers who learn.
Believers whose character makes their faith visible.

Because the answer to a growing intellectual challenge cannot be anger.

It must be knowledge.
It must be wisdom.
It must be character.

And above all...

It must be truth.

Thank you.